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What is the current Scenario of India-China w.r.t border issue?

The tranquility at the border has gone, for the 1st time in 40 years where has been clashes & loss of life.

Since, when China has started changing its posture? -

- Since, Xi-Xingping came to power in 2012.

Why Xi-Xingping has given such ambitious plan?

- To consolidate his position in domestic politics.

When he came to power the Rate of Economic Growth of China started Declining.

Why? -

- B/c of Global Financial Crisis.

The legitimacy of Communist Party of China depend on its ability to deliver higher Economic Growth. This was also the reason behind the signature initiative of Xi-Xingping i.e. BRI. China wanted to divert the attention by raising Nationalist sentiments.

In 2012, Xi-Xingping came to power & in 2013 there was incursions in 'Depsang Region' (near Siachen). Still China has not dis-engaged from Depsang.

In 2014, there was incursion in Chumar (near Demchok). China have not even dis-engaged from here.

In Feb 2023, 15th Round of Talk took place b/w High level Military officials of both the countries where India demanded -

- i) Dis-engagement from Depsang, Demchok & Hot-spring Region. However, China has not agreed.
- ii) India has also objected to Chinese Action preventing the movement of Indian Patrolling team.

Foreign Minister S. Jaishankar described the State of relation as abnormal.

In 2017, China again entered into Doklam Region. Thus, China has been continuing with its strategy of "Salami-slicing" (gradually acquiring the territory).

Response of India :-

Though India maintained assertive posture at Doklam yet India tried to de-fuse the crisis & wanted to start the Engagement. Hence, India initiated the diplomacy of informal Summits.

↳ In 2018, Informal Summit at Wuhan & in 2019 at Mamallapuram (Tamil Nadu).

In 2019, Covid Crisis started & China's action was too surprising. Instead of accepting the responsibility, China started "Wolf Warrior Diplomacy".

India continued to maintain the friendly posture, still China continued with its aggressive design. The "Modus Vivendi" agreed in 1993 was broken, resulting into the violence at Galwan.

• Modus Vivendi means term of Engagement.

Presently, India wants to ~~restore~~^{renew} the status. China should observe its ~~status~~^{commitment} under 1993 agreement & 1996 agreement. However, China is not in the mood of Engagement.

What is China's ~~Mood~~ ? —

China has already started war with India. Chinese strategic culture is greatly influence by Chinese Strategist Sun Tzu, the author of Art of War to suggest to wage war by other mean.

China has already started Waging wars by another means. (Sub-Kinetic Warfare)

↳ Means wars in various domain & not directly in battle field.

What are Chinese Strategy of War against India?—

—China has launched the war at Multiple Fronts!—

- i) Cyber Attack.
- ii) Space War
- iii) Propaganda War
- iv) Containment of India by expanding its presence in South Asia.
- v) Challenging India's position in Indian Ocean.
- vi) Using the tactics, to prevent access to South-China Sea.
- vii) Promoting Sub-Version in border Region.
- viii) Trade War.

India - China trade deficit has become unsustainable. China is dumping the Goods. The Bilateral trade in 2021 reach to \$ 125.7 billion.

The trade deficit in 2020 was \$ 45.9 billion. w/c has become in 2021 \$ 69.4 billion.

Some of the initiative taken by China include:-

i) Development of infrastructure in border Region.

a) A Railway line connecting Tibbet Shigaste to Yatong running across Sikkim.

b) From Shigaste to Nyingchi running across Arunachal Pradesh.

ii) Sino - Nepal Highway.

iii) ~~40~~ 14th Five Year Plan (2021-2025)

↳ they have plan to built Airport, upgrade National Highways & to built high speed railway connecting Chengdu to Lhasa.

- they have plan to built 628 Xiaoking Villages in Border Regions. The ^{every} theme is Every village is to be a Fortress & ^{every} house watch-post.

iv) China is unifying its western theatre command, Developing high altitude War force.

The most important initiative has been CPEC Corridor. In ~~face~~ of War, China will be able to escape its Malakka Dilemma.

CPEC Corridor is primarily for Military Purpose. China has led the Fibre optics Network connecting Kashgar with Gwadar.

China is also helping in the Military Modernisation of Pakistan specially Strengthening its Maritime Capacity. China is providing submarine, China has a plan to give its aircraft carrier Liaoning to Pakistan on lease.

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They are also involved in co-production of 5 Generation J-20 Stealth Aircraft.

China also providing Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV) to Pakistan.

Chinese Group TAG 28 is involve in snooping. It is considered to be State sponsored platform.

China has already threatened India's security by making inroads in Communication technology.

China is also using diplomatic means. For eg- preventing India's entry in NSG, permanent member in UNSC, making constant efforts to whittle down India's diplomatic initiatives like - Neighbourhood.

First, SAARC and BIMSTEC.

China is also building PLASSF (Peoples Liberation Army Special Space Force).

China is hijacking India's Soft Power w.r.t. Buddhism.

Hence, it is high time policy makers in India should realise that we are already in the situation of war. War in present times will be fought in Multiple Domains & will be a tough challenge for India. India has to catchup fast. Since it will not be possible to balance the Power of China simply by internal balancing. India will have to look for external balancing - India has to work with like-minded countries. India has already started taking the serious steps to manage Chinese Challenge.

What are Indian Steps to manage China's Challenge?—

- i) India - U.S. Strategic Partnership
- ii) Strategic Partnership with other QUAD countries.
- iii) Strategic Partnership with Russia.
- iv) Look East to Act East Policy.
- v) New approach towards Maritime Security.
- vi) Western QUAD.
- vii) Neighbourhood First Policy.
- viii) SAGAR

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NOTE!—

2013 !— Border Defence Co-operation Agreement.

— It was agreed during the visit of Manmohan Singh after Chinese incursion. It was a Confidence Building measure to prevent LAC turning into

"Red line". As per the agreement in case Patrolling team of one country enters into the Region under the control of the other!—

- a) both will act with restrain.
- b) Immediate Hot-line b/w the Officials.
- c) No tailing of the Patrolling

China has violated this agreement also. Now India-China require "New Modus Vivendi"

What should be India's approach towards China?—

— It should be focus on internal development & maintain Peaceful Periphery. W.r.t. China, the Guiding principle at present should be Engagement wherever possible, Containment wherever necessary. The Geo-political situation is changing fast. Hence, India should avoid Putting 'all axes in one basket'. Means India should go for multiple alignment to assert its Strategic Autonomy

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India should not forget the Golden Rule of International Politics.

In International Politics, Nations are either in the state of war or in the preparation of war. Even when we want to avoid war the only way is to be prepared for war. In 21st Century, speed has become the determinant of Power. The Rule of 21st Century is —
"Survival of Fastest rather than Fittest".

— As suggested by Morganthu, the First lesson for a serious student of International Relation is to realise that complexities of International Politics make "simple solutions and trust worthy Prophecies impossible".

* India - U.S.A. Relation *

What is the background of India-U.S. Relation?
- China is the common factor.

* Evolution of India-U.S. Relation and the Milestone :-

1st Phase:- "During Cold War."

a) Estrange Democracy - A term coined by Dennis Kux.

2nd Phase:- "Post Cold War"

From estrange Democracy they have become engaged democracy.

↳ At present time, the official status of India and U.S. are - that they are comprehensive Global Strategic Partners.

They are engaged at the level of 2 + 2 dialogue.
They shows that India - U.S. ~~relat~~ Strategic Partnership has become institutionalised.

How officials describe the Relations ?

- Former U.S. Secretary of State **Hilary Clinton** called India as indispensable Partner. Similarly, former U.S. President ^{OBAMA} called India - U.S. partnership as the most defining Partnership of 21st Century.

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Whether it is a National Security Policy of Trump or Biden, almost all official documents released by U.S. administration describe Russia and China as a threat and India as a Strategic Partner.

In recent years, India is the only country with which the relations of U.S.A. have improved.

U.S.A.'s relations have seen the downward trend even with its allies.

How U.S.A. looks towards India?

What is U.S.A.'s Grand Strategy towards India?

- India has always been an important country in Geo-political Calculations of U.S.A.:-

i) India's location in Indian Ocean.

ii) India's location w.r.t Eurasia.

For. E.g.:- W.r.t China and if we talk about

India before Partition, its borders were adjacent to Iran, Afghanistan & Central Asia.

↳ that time part of U.S.S.R.

Hence, U.S.A. wanted to bring India under its sphere of influence.

In Strategic Calculus of India emerges as the ideal swing State.

Why India is an Ideal Swing State?

- Ideal B/c both are liberal democracies, open society.

At the same time, India's Strategic Culture.

India does not have Hegemonic Aspiration. India has pluralistic vision.

For U.S.A, India is not threatening though irritating

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Teresita Schaffer, in her book — "India on high table of Diplomacies" has highlighted India's Strategic Culture.

A/c to her, it becomes difficult to deal with India b/c at times Indians do not understand if some advice is given in their favour.

* 1st Phase: — "Cold - War"

1st Phase: — (1947 - 1965) —

— From very beginning U.S.A wanted to bring India under its sphere of influence. However, India preferred the Policy of Non-Alignment.

Hence, Non-Alignment as a posture for India's Foreign Policy became major irritant.

Though India was Non-Aligned yet it Non-Aligned Posture was never balanced. It was tilted towards the communist block.

Still U.S.A. continued to provide the Military & Developmental aid to India as well as Pakistan to bring India under its influence.

India did not support U.S. Resolution against North-Korea in Korean Crisis. India kept on supporting China's candidature as a permanent member of UNSC in place of Taiwan.

Still, U.S.A supported India's position in 1962 War. U.S.A helped in the establishment of IIT Kanpur i.e. collaboration in higher education.

U.S.A helped India to address its Food Security. India launched Green Revolution in 1963 with the support of U.S.A.

Even after 1962 War, India maintained its Non-Aligned status. Hence, U.S.A left India for better Partner i.e. Pakistan.

* 2nd Phase! — (1965 — 1991) —

— By 1965, U.S. and Pakist axis started developing. Pakistan's importance, had increased w.r.t Containment of USSR. By this time, there has been Sino-Soviet Rift. U.S. wanted to bring China under its sphere of influence. Hence, U.S.A wanted inter-Locator. Pakistan played the role of bringing U.S. — China together. Thus, emerge U.S. — Pakistan — China axis. It has created enough pressure on India that India had to leave the Genuine Posture of Non-Alignment, had to seek external balancing by entering into Treaty of Peace and Friendship with USSR in 1971.

Article 9 of the treaty gave security Guarantee to India. The treaty gave confidence to India to intervene in East Pakistan & to create Bangladesh. In 1971 War, both China and U.S.A threatened India. U.S.A had sent same "USS Enterprise" to Bay of Bengal to Pressurise India.

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After 1971 War, India U.S. Relations reached to their lowest point. Giving rise to the Phrase—
"Estrange Democracies."

What was the approach of U.S.A during this phase w.r.t India? —

— Since, Indian Economy was closed Economy, it hardly had any attraction for U.S.A.

U.S.A. didn't have even Independent Policy for India.

U.S.A had South Asia Policy.

↳ It is known as Hyphenation of India and Pakistan.

Thus, U.S. policy towards India was governed by the Priorities of Pakistan.

↳ Kashmir. —

- i) U.S.A provided consistent support to Pakistan diplomatically. In UNSC, Russia was support for India as Russia vetoed UNSC Resolutions on Kashmir, targetting India
- ii) U.S.A provided Economic and Military aid to Pakistan, w/c allowed Pakistan to pressurise India.
- iii) U.S.A's CIA and Pakistan's ISI have been working together to promote Islamic Jihad in Afghanistan to topple Communist Govt. / Pro-Soviet Govt. in Afghanistan.

Pakistan has used the opportunity to promote the terrorism in Kashmir. The nature of insurgency in Kashmir changed.

Original Nature:-

— Initially insurgency in Kashmir was led by the local groups. The agenda of these organisations like — JULF was secular. They stood for independent identity of Kashmir i.e. Kashmiriyat.

o JULF
↓
Jammu-Kashmir
Liberation Front.

However, by mid 1980s, the nature of militancy changed. The foreign militants were brought in Kashmir and militancy was given Jihadi Texture. The nomenclature of militant groups changed. E.g.:- Hizbul Mujahiddin, Jaish-e-Mohammad.

The most important aspects of U.S. policy was to pressurise India to sign NPT.